this has been traced by scholars to Columbus' expedition of 1492, the expedition and its significance for world history has engendered a raging debate.

One school of thought, the 'modern' school, believes that Columbus' voyage was and must be seen as a 'glorious and heroic achievement' that marked the beginning of the Christian West's 'destiny' to 'liberate' non-Christian indigenous societies from their wretched existence.[12] The second school of thought, the 'postmodern' school, is seen as a response to Europe's claims over modernity and rejects the grand narratives woven around it. However, this school's opposition to modernism is largely in the realm of culture.

The third school, namely the postcolonial school, which enjoys a significant overlap with postmodern thought and even draws from it, too rejects the universalising claims of Eurocentrism albeit in the political realm; however, it uses the very same tools as the coloniser instead of deconstructing and questioning colonial presumptions.[13] For instance, while the postcolonial school focuses on the local, it tries to universalise the local, thereby falling prey to the same universalising tendency of colonialism. In other words, the postcolonial school certainly changes the *content* of the discussion but not the *terms of engagement* or the *framework* of the discussion, having imbibed the European penchant for universalisation.[14] The limitations of the postcolonial school, among other things, lie in its inability to see and comprehend the continued contemporary impact of colonial structures even after decolonisation.

The fourth school, namely the decolonial school, akin to postcolonialism, challenges European universalisms, particularly in the political realm. It too believes that Columbus' voyage marked the beginning of one of the most repressive, bloody, racist and genocidal chapters ever witnessed in human history that led to the extinction of several cultures and, critically, wreaked havoc on nature on an unprecedented scale. However, where the decolonial school differs from postcolonial thought is its identification of the element of 'coloniality', which, according to it, informed European colonisation that began with the Age of Discovery. According to decolonial thought, European coloniality gave birth to the 'cultural complex' of 'modernity' and 'rationality', apart from the 'modern' categories of religion and race. Importantly, according to the decolonial school, 'postcolonialism' gives the impression that the colonial mindset or consciousness ended with